



The rise of Siri

Siri is synonymous with Apple now, yet she was unheard of even five years ago. Where did this AI assistant come from? And what lies in the future for her? We find out.

For most Digit readers, HAL 9000 was probably the first interactions they had with an Artificial Intelligence that acted as an assistant. If you Gen-Z newcomers are confused, HAL 9000 is the infamous sentient AI that acted as the assistant on a spaceship in Arthur C. Clarke's 2001: A Space Odyssey. This, possibly, is the most oblique way to get into the nitty gritty of the AI voice assistant that we know as Siri. Nonetheless, it should be known that one of the earliest projects to create a voice assistant was known as 'HAL', and had the tagline "HAL's back – but this time he's good."